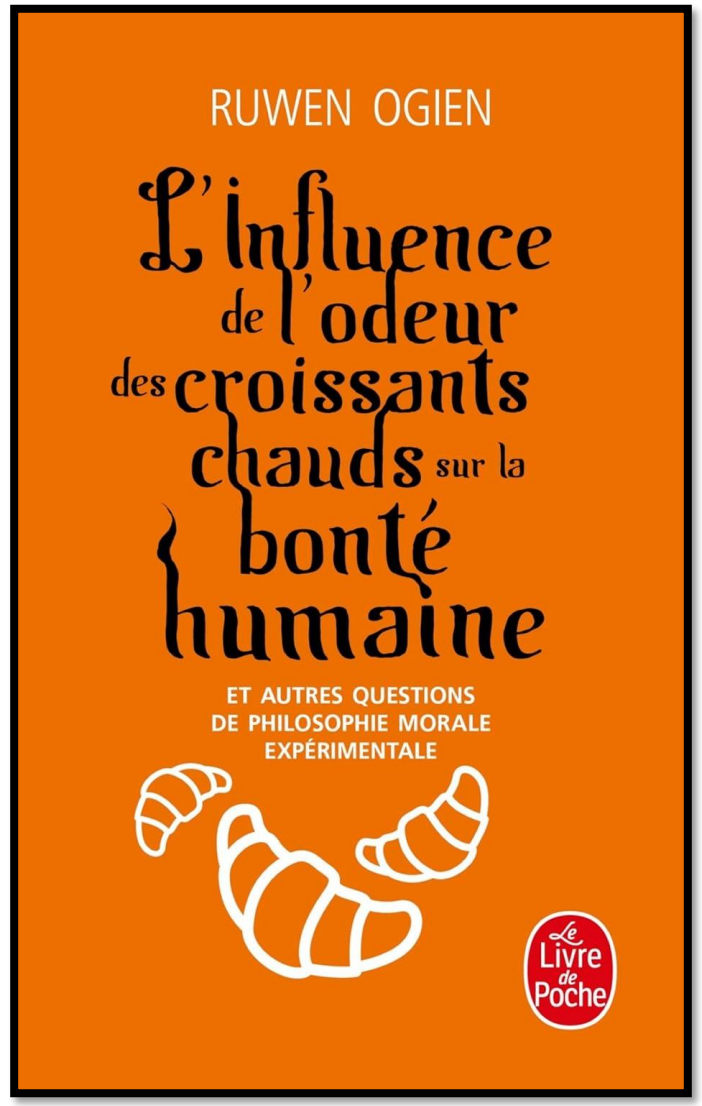
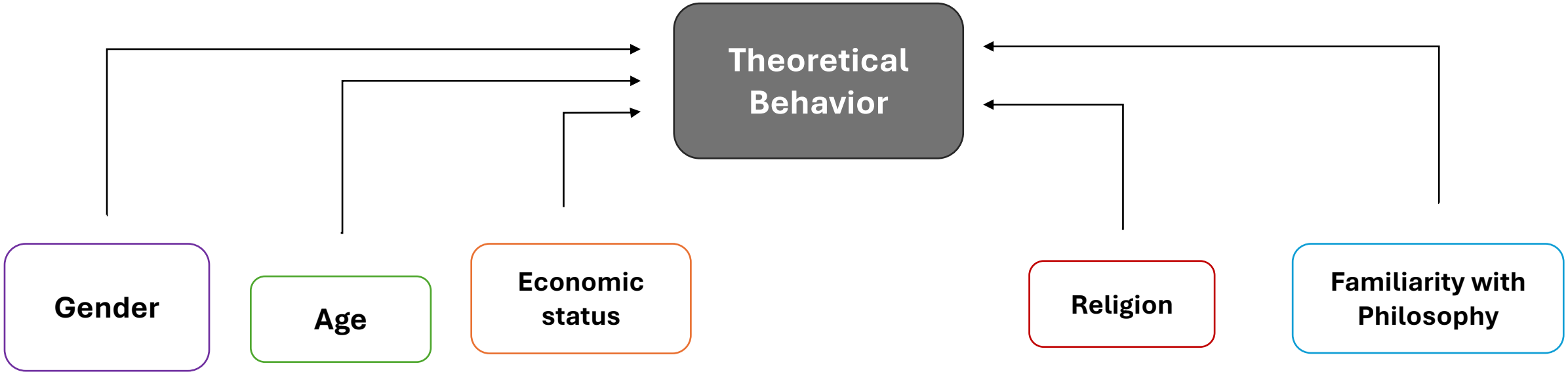

RUWEN OGIEN
L'influence de l'odeur des croissants chauds sur la bonté humaine
ET AUTRES QUESTIONS DE PHILOSOPHIE MORALE EXPÉRIMENTALE
Le Livre de Poche

Are you predictable ?

Theoretical Behavior

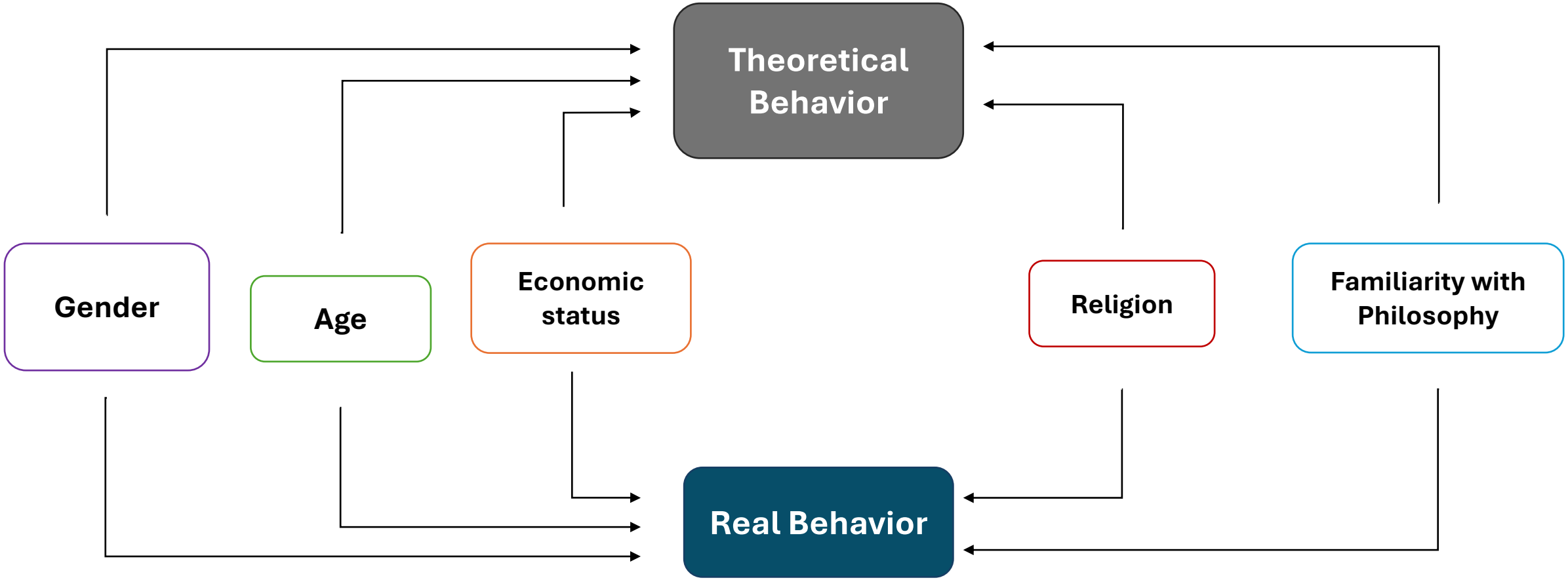
P1 – Theoretical behavior is influenced by an individual's profile
P2 – Real behavior is influenced by an individual's profile
P3 – Theoretical behavior reflects the real behavior



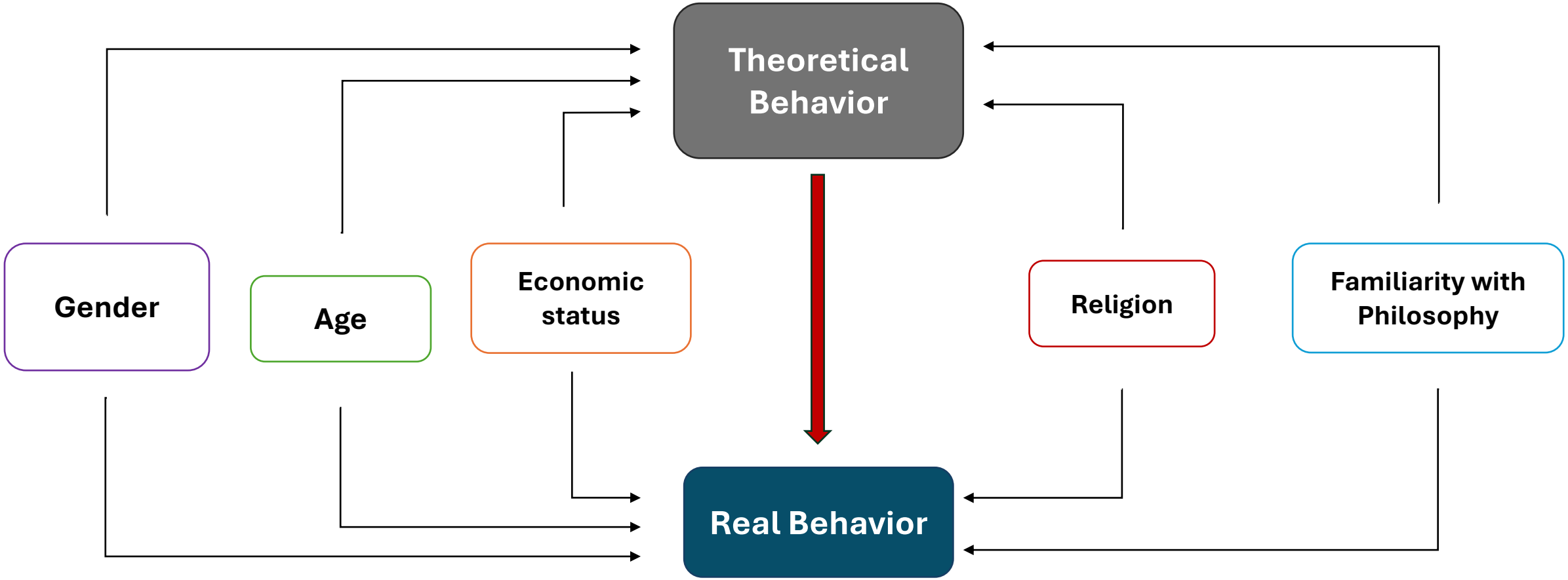
P1 – Theoretical behavior is influenced by an individual's profile

P2 – Real behavior is influenced by an individual's profile

P3 – Theoretical behavior reflects the real behavior



P1 – Theoretical behavior is influenced by an individual's profile
P2 – Real behavior is influenced by an individual's profile
P3 – Theoretical behavior reflects the real behavior



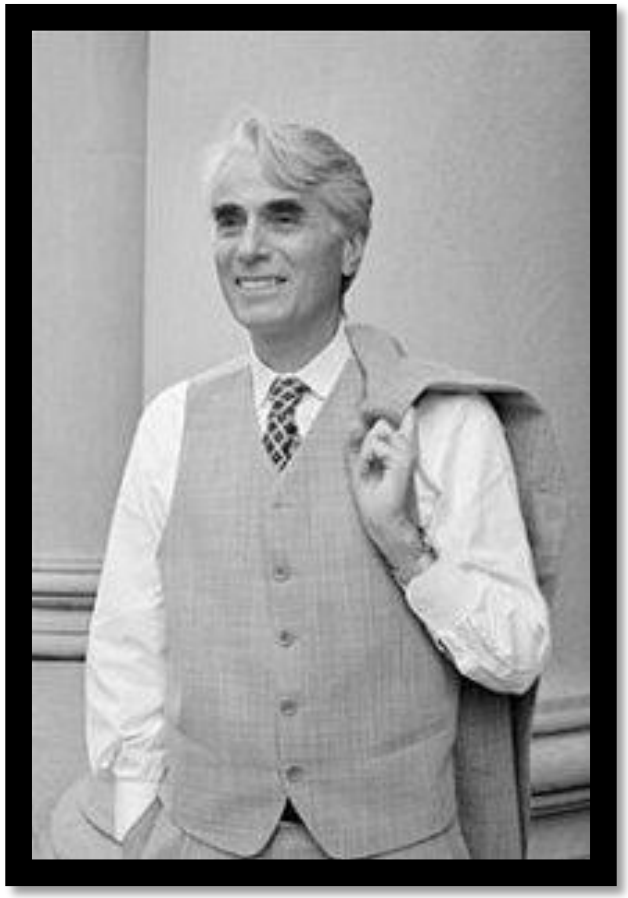
P1 – Theoretical behavior is influenced by an individual's profile
P2 – Real behavior is influenced by an individual's profile
P3 – Theoretical behavior reflects the real behavior

Data

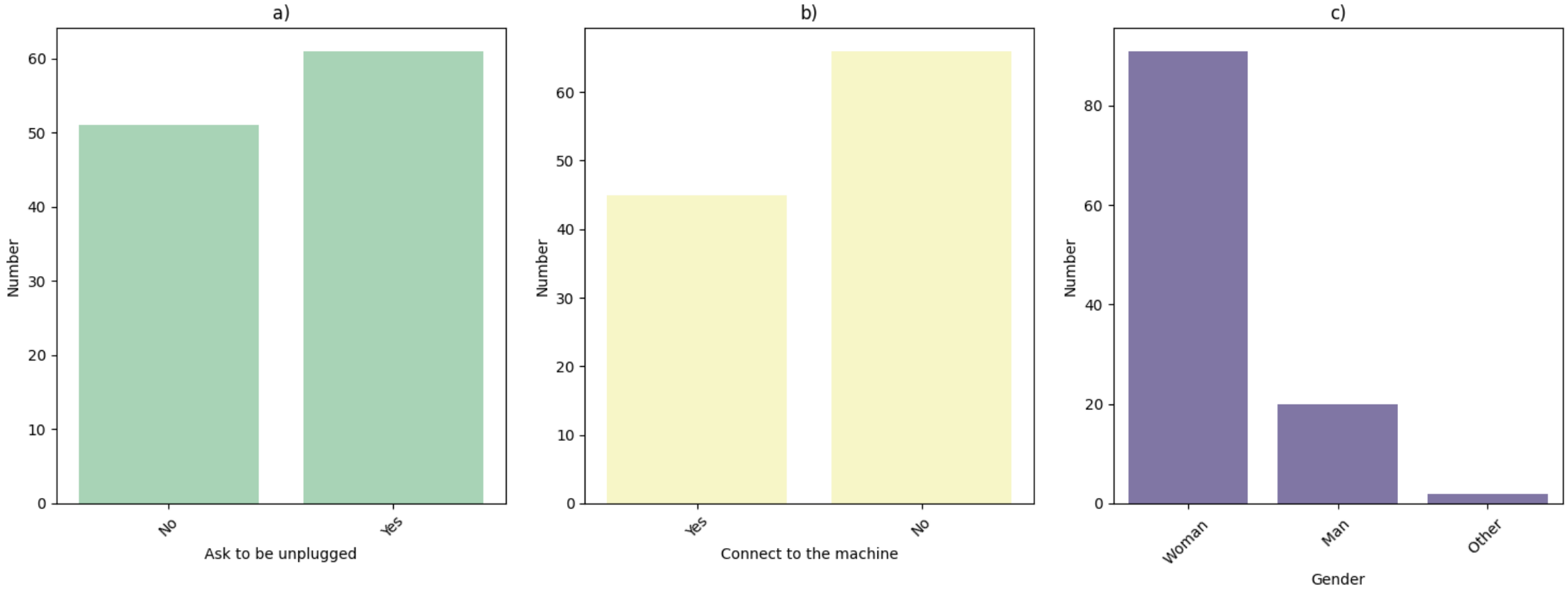
Dataset comes from a questionnaire with 115 answers collecting :

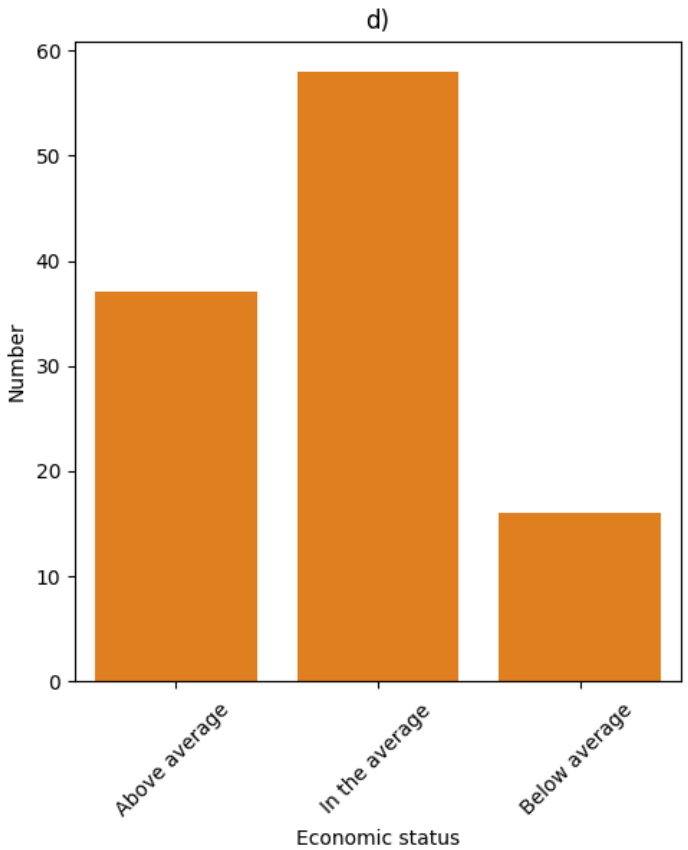
- Information on the profile of the respondent : Age, Gender, Study Level, Economic Status, Religious Status and Familiarity with moral philosophy
- Answers from 2 different thought experience created by Jarvis Thomson and Robert Nozick
- Answers about 2 real behavior : opinion about abortion and if the person felt disappointed by a lie with good intentions

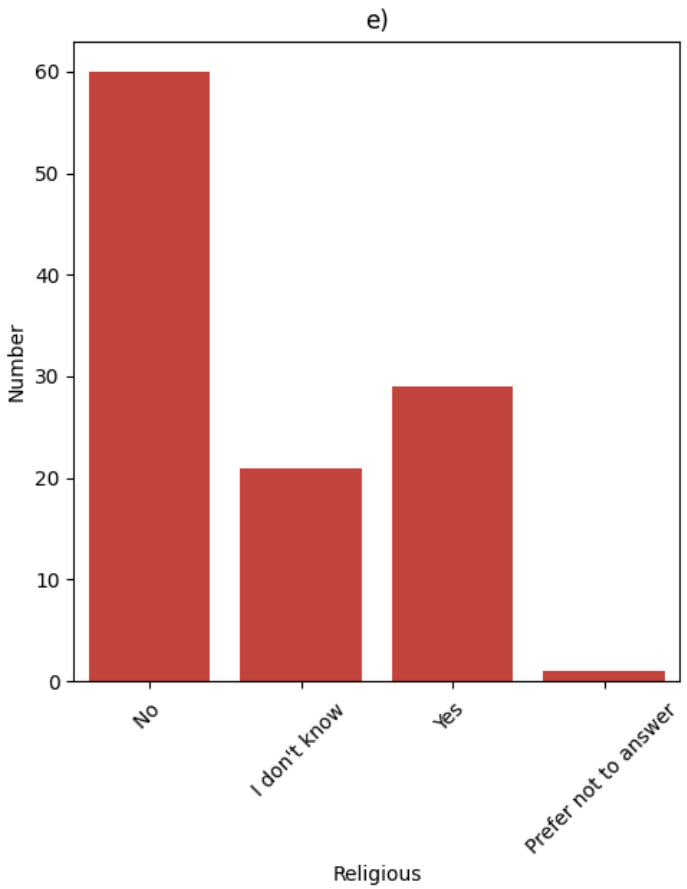
Judith Thomson, « A defense of Abortion », *Philosophy & Public Affairs*

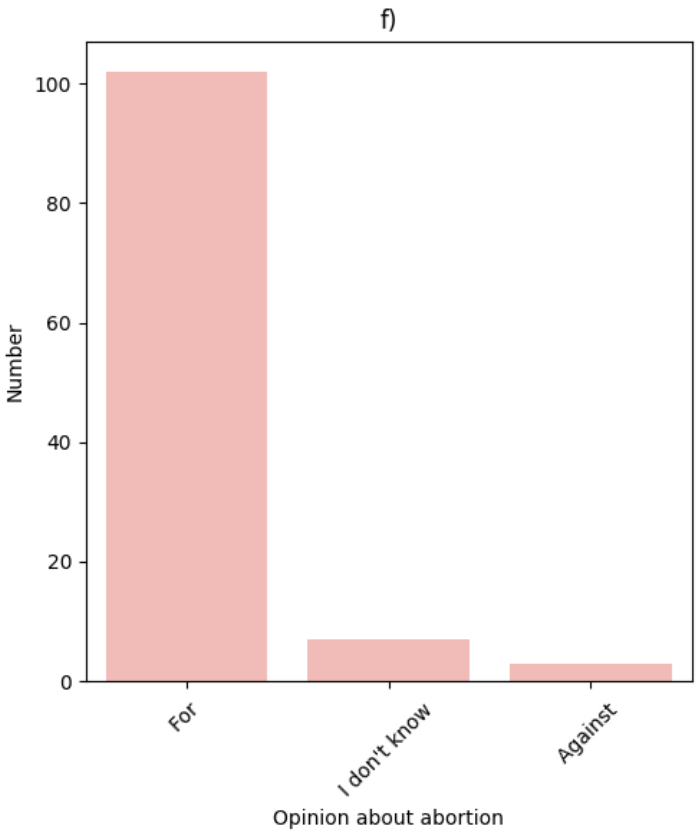


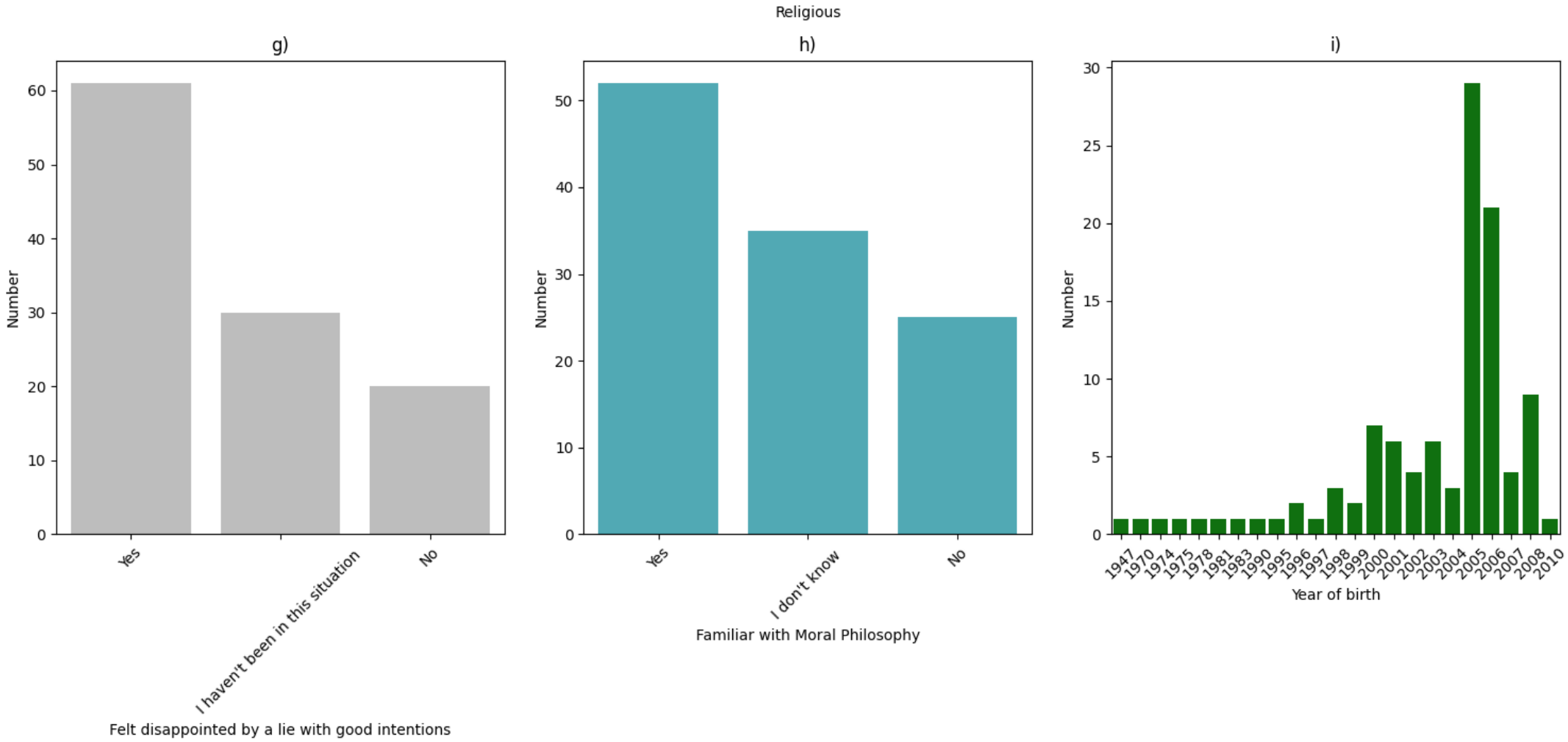
Robert Nozick, *Anarchy, State, and Utopia*

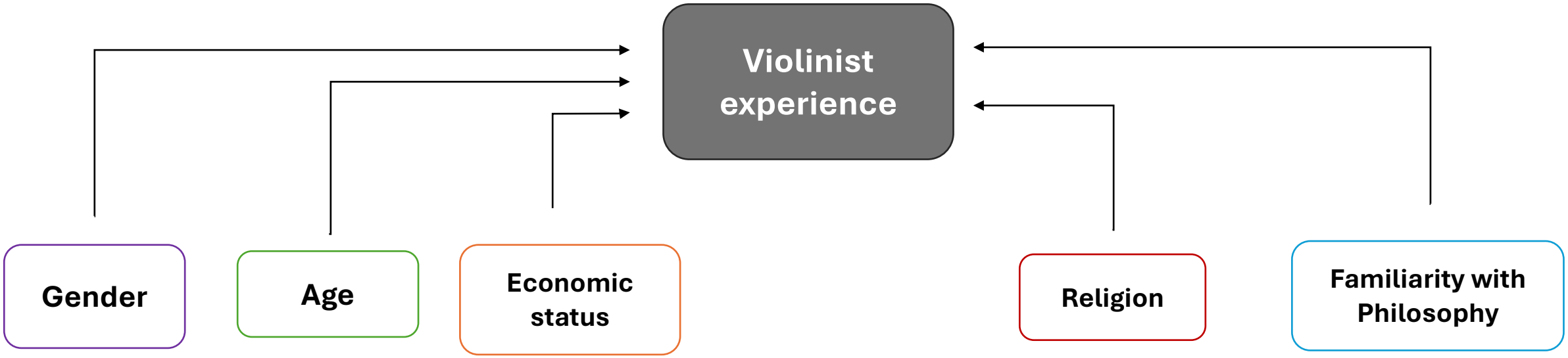

a)
Number
0
10
20
30
40
50
60
No
Yes
Ask to be unplugged
b)
Number
0
10
20
30
40
50
60
Yes
No
Connect to the machine
c)
Number
0
20
40
60
80
Woman
Man
Other
Gender


d)
Number
0
10
20
30
40
50
60
Above average
In the average
Below average
Economic status

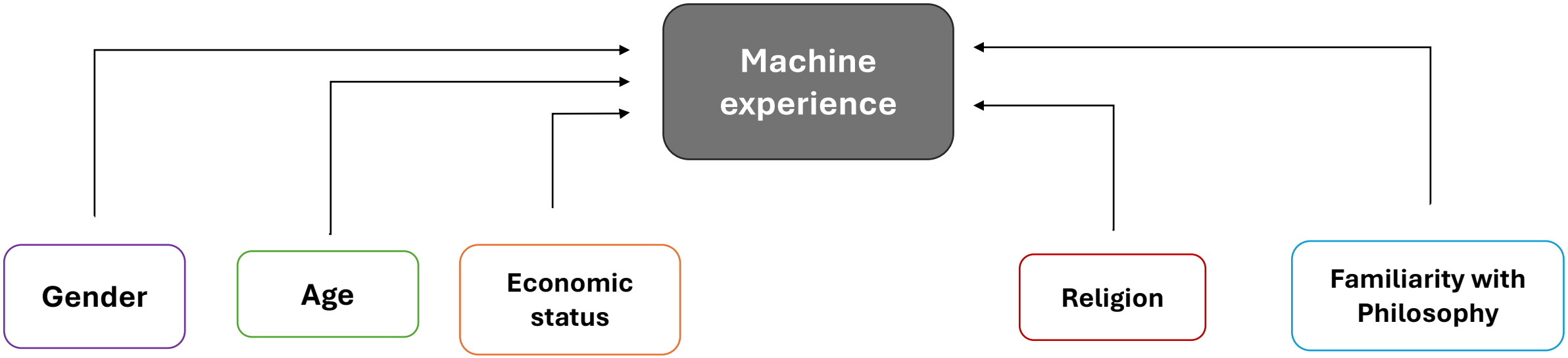

e)
Number
0
10
20
30
40
50
60
No
I don't know
Yes
Prefer not to answer
Religious


f)
Number
0
20
40
60
80
100
For
I don't know
Against
Opinion about abortion

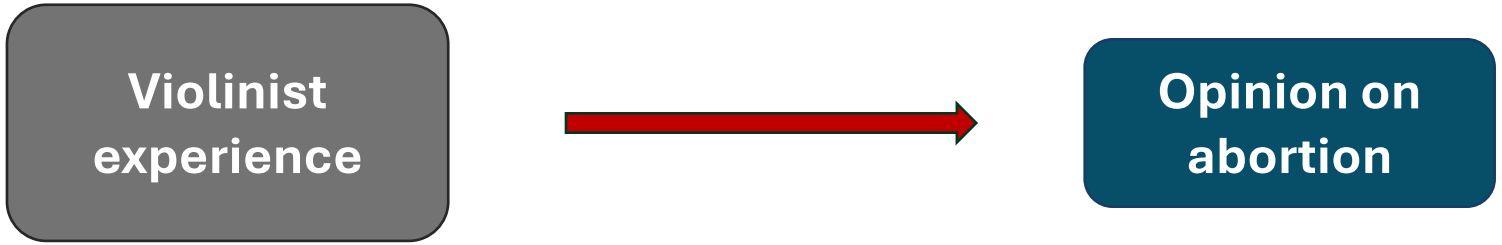

Religious
g)
h)
i)
Number
Yes
I haven't been in this situation
No
Felt disappointed by a lie with good intentions
I don't know
Familiar with Moral Philosophy
1947
1970
1974
1975
1978
1981
1983
1990
1995
1996
1997
1998
1999
2000
2001
2002
2003
2004
2005
2006
2007
2008
2010
Year of birth



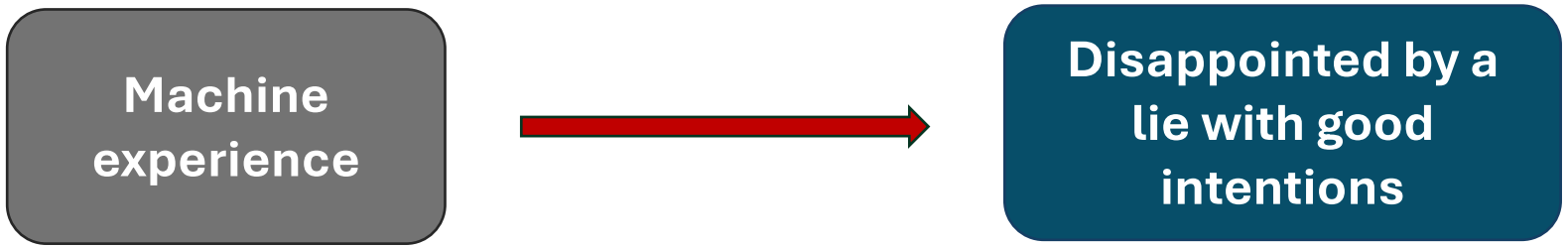
	Coefficient	P-value
Economy	-1,044	0,030
Gender	2,200	0,009
Religion	-0,458	0,143
Familiarity with moral philosophy	-1,078	0,140
Age	-0,010	0,960



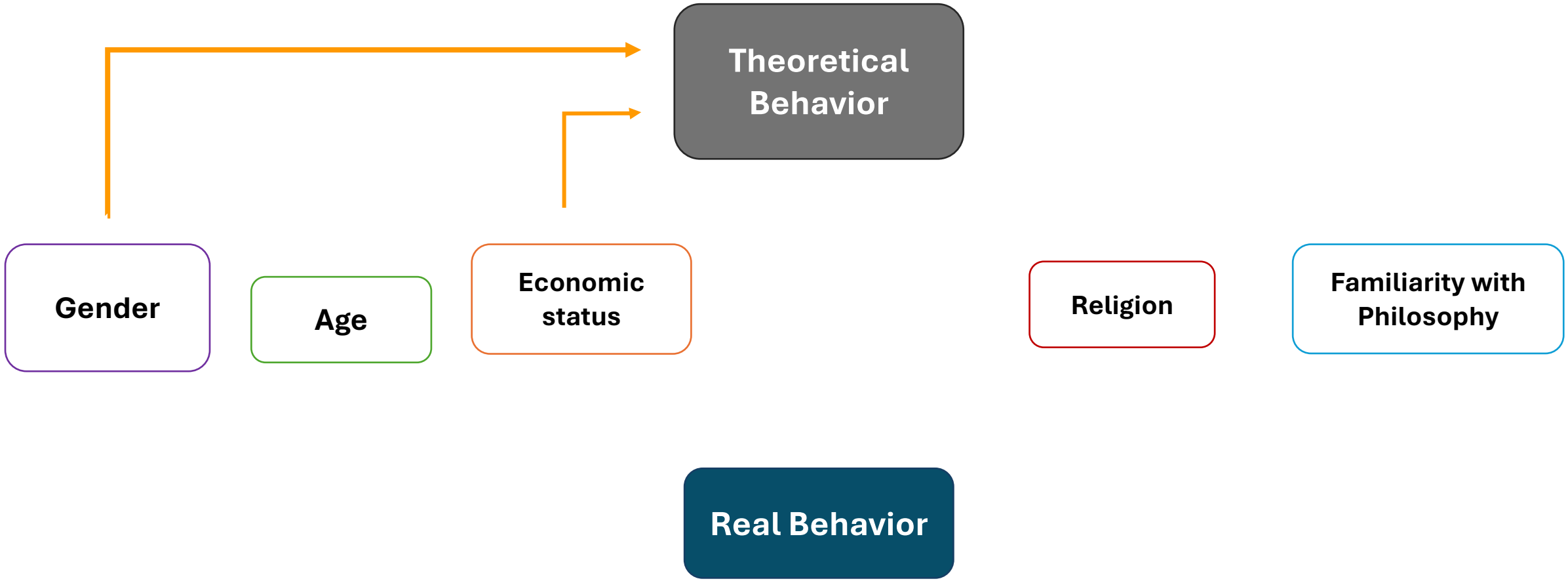
	Coefficient	P-value
Economy	-1,442	0,290
Gender	-0,344	0,632
Religion	-0,250	0,387
Familiarity with moral philosophy	0,400	0,550
Age	-0,020	0,481



P- value = 0,360


Machine experience
Disappointed by a lie with good intentions

P- value = 0,484


Theoretical Behavior
Gender
Age
Economic status
Religion
Familiarity with Philosophy
Real Behavior

Conclusion

- We cannot predict the behavior of an individual in real and theoretical situations only through his profile, except for certain cases, such as gender or economic status for the thought experience of the violinist of Judith Thomson.

- Moreover, it would seem that we cannot predict the response to the real case from the response to a thought experience.

Perspective

- We may plan to expand the scope of respondents to the questionnaire in order to check if this is still the case with a wider diversity in responses.
- This may mean that the thought experiences are not similar enough to the actual cases proposed, which would explain this difference in respondents' answers.
- Perhaps it should be done by some other means than a questionnaire, such as real-life experience.